Dalya Elmalt

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University of Wisconsin–Madison
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Citizenship: International

Education

University of Wisconsin–Madison
Ph.D. in Economics — Expected 2027
M.S. in Economics — 2024
Institute for Research on Poverty, Graduate Research Fellow

University of Chicago
M.A. in Social Sciences (Economics) — 2017
B.A. in Economics — 2016

Research Interests

Industrial Organization, Health Economics, Risk and Insurance Markets

References

Ashley Swanson (Advisor)
Associate Professor
UW–Madison
608-262-5897
swanson25@wisc.edu

Alan Sorensen
Professor
UW–Madison
608-263-3867
sorensen@ssc.wisc.edu

Naoki Aizawa
Associate Professor
UW–Madison
608-262-9250
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Job Market Paper

The Doctor's Pen and the Payer's Bargain: Insurer Ownership of Primary Care

Lawmakers are moving to ban insurers from owning physician practices. Vertical integration can be efficient, if it eliminates double marginalization and disciplines hospital prices; consumers gain if the savings reach premiums. It can also be harmful, through foreclosure of rival insurers and inflating what the government pays Medicare Advantage plans. I study which forces dominate when an insurer is able to have market power in the primary care market, using a model in which insurers and practices bargain over prices and physicians choose how to code and refer patients. I find that rival insurers pay about 13 percent more for the same commercial office visit at the acquired clinics. The integrated insurer does not negotiate lower hospital prices, and its Medicare Advantage premiums do not fall relative to rivals'. Medicare pays more for enrollees of the integrated insurer post acquisition, despite no change in the care they receive. Specialist referrals fall by about 13 percent, with no change in hospital admissions or urgent care. In a market with the average U.S. hospital and physician concentration but with fragmented commercial insurers, the harms of integration dominate its efficiencies.

Working Papers

Hospitals, Insurers, and the Variation in Negotiated Prices: Evidence from Transparency in Coverage Data

ESG Investing: Only Part of the Climate Puzzle (with Deniz Igan and Divya Kirti)
CEPR Discussion Paper 16061, 2021; revised September 2023.
Earlier version: IMF Working Paper 21/112, "Limits to Private Climate Change Mitigation," 2021

Presentations

UW–Madison IO Workshop; International Monetary Fund

Teaching Experience

University of Wisconsin–Madison

Head TA, Principles of Microeconomics – Steve Trost	Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024
TA, Principles of Microeconomics – Steve Trost	Fall 2022, Spring 2023

Research Experience

Research Officer, International Monetary Fund	2019–2020
Junior Research Scientist, Finance Department, New York University	2017–2019
Research Assistant, Energy Policy Institute at the University of Chicago	2015

Honors and Awards

Jeff Metcalf Summer Research Award, University of Chicago	2015
Sawiris Scholar	2013–2016

Additional

Restricted-use data: Oregon All Payer All Claims database (APAC)
Programming: Python, Stata, R, Julia, SQL/DuckDB, LaTeX
Languages: Arabic (native), English (fluent)

Last updated October 2026